

*Please make a copy of this entire
document and then add your name
& link your document to this
Class Presentation Links Document*



THOT BUBBLES

*Seattle's Queer
Culture Magazine*

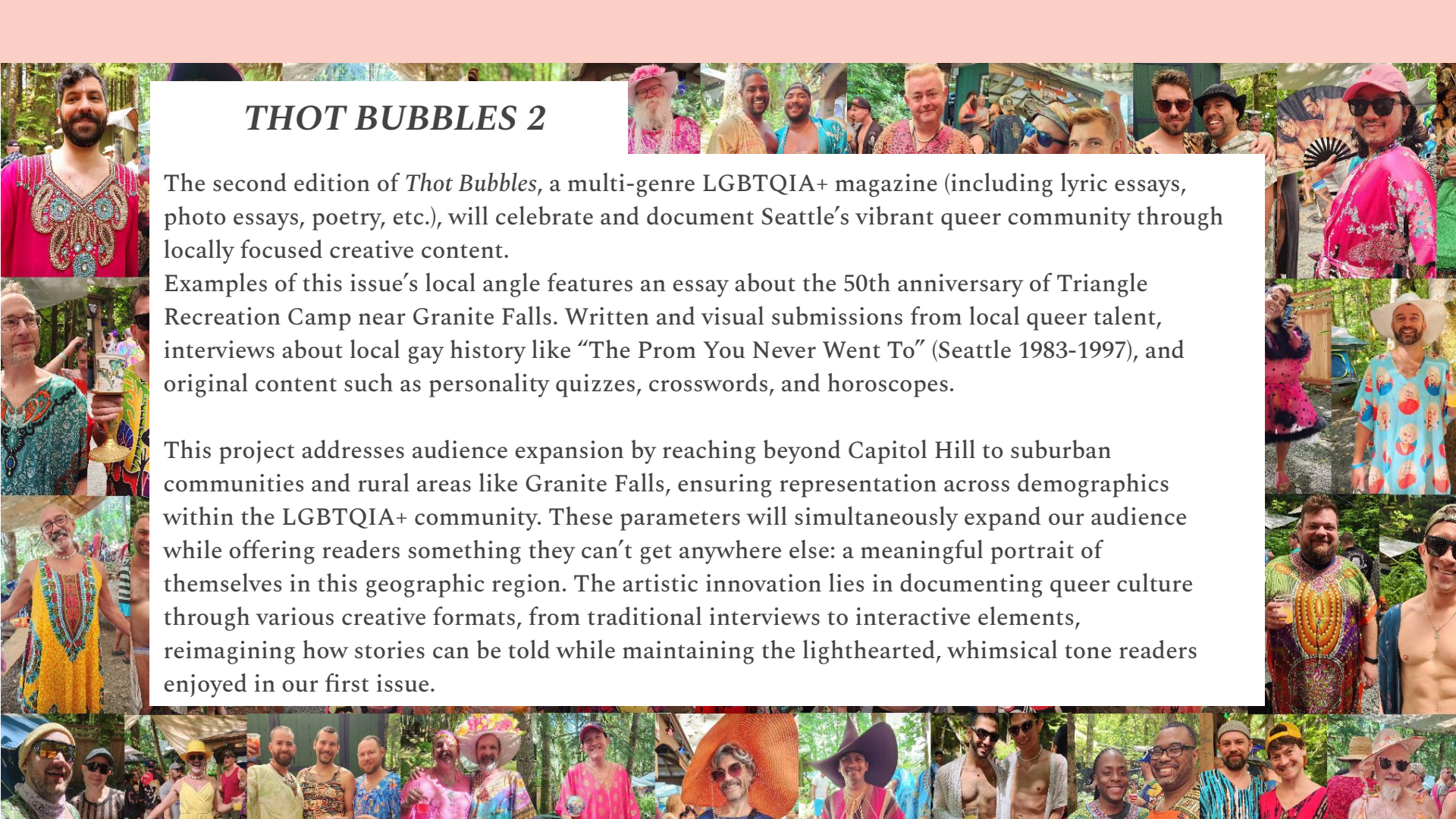
*Contemporary faggotry
making love to queer history*



Contemporary Faggotry

making love to

Queer history



THOT BUBBLES 2

The second edition of *Thot Bubbles*, a multi-genre LGBTQIA+ magazine (including lyric essays, photo essays, poetry, etc.), will celebrate and document Seattle's vibrant queer community through locally focused creative content.

Examples of this issue's local angle features an essay about the 50th anniversary of Triangle Recreation Camp near Granite Falls. Written and visual submissions from local queer talent, interviews about local gay history like "The Prom You Never Went To" (Seattle 1983-1997), and original content such as personality quizzes, crosswords, and horoscopes.

This project addresses audience expansion by reaching beyond Capitol Hill to suburban communities and rural areas like Granite Falls, ensuring representation across demographics within the LGBTQIA+ community. These parameters will simultaneously expand our audience while offering readers something they can't get anywhere else: a meaningful portrait of themselves in this geographic region. The artistic innovation lies in documenting queer culture through various creative formats, from traditional interviews to interactive elements, reimagining how stories can be told while maintaining the lighthearted, whimsical tone readers enjoyed in our first issue.

General audience & reader personas

General Audience:

Queer and queer adjacent adults of the PNW

Community “Elders”

Queer individuals 50+ who have paved the way and continue to keep our community thriving.
Seeing themselves reflected and respected as a key throughline.



Scott & Randy
Patrons & Event Founders

Out & About Fags

The Seattle Queerdos:
Nightlife Goers, Gender Transgressors
Cross-generational readers looking for
information, inspiration.



Beau Degas - Local Artist

Local Queer Trendsetters

21+ artists and scene makers of the
current future Queermunity. Culminating
diverse perspectives on Queerness,
aesthetics, and activism.



Typeface Name: Utopia

Typeface Point Size/Leading: 9 .5/12

Notes on Camp

*Homosexuals constitute the vanguard – and most
articulate audience – of Camp.*

—Susan Sontag

platforms in the trees.

Seven years later, TRC feels as delightful as ever. This weekend we're camping with Jeremy and Jeffrey, our Seattle friends. Earlier this morning at the picnic table, Jeffrey looped a kaftan around his head until its monstera pattern climbed into the sky. Jeremy cooked breakfast burritos wearing only a jock strap.

"You look like Celine Dion on her wedding day," Jeremy said, cracking two eggs in a pan.

"There's hope for me after all," Jeffrey said.

"We always have hope," Jeremy said, dropping the shells in the carton. "We have to. As long as Diana Ross is Ashlee Simpson's mother-in-law. I heard that's the rule."

Back at the river, the guys behind me keep chatting. I turn around to look. "When you're cute," a young guy says, stepping out of his tent, "all you

Typeface: Utopia

The use of Utopia mimics 1970s newspaper fonts without defaulting the overly clean Times New Romans. The goal is to find a font that balances

Modern and Traditional

Rounded, bubble-like counters with crisp legibility

Gay Whimsy with reverence for history

The font family has a wide range allowing it to function as a bold display header and a legible body.

DAZZLE UNICASE FUNCTIONS AS AN OPTION FOR LARGE PURELY GRAPHIC LETTERING. ESPECIALLY FOR THE ROUNDED O.

Liebelgerda is an option for typing in hand script from old photos, letters, and select posters

Fraunces brings another accent font for retro newspaper headline textures

Sample inspiration

Gay Liberation 'trying to break down barriers'

By MARY ANN DIEHL,
Daily Hinel Staff Writer

Gay Liberation, an organized force of homosexuals at the University for two years, is a group of students and University employees politically and socially oriented towards civil rights, according to Mark Rogers, treasurer.

Gay Liberation was formed with a direction dictated by members to break down the stereotypes of homosexuals and to "bring out" inhibited gay people into a world they had been deliberately hidden and excluded from in the past.

It has worked to expell a guilt society has cast on the members through numerous teach-ins, dances, picnics, panel discussions

Rogers said Gay Liberation had a conflict with the Wigwam, a local restaurant, for its discrimination against gay people last year.

"But most people in the University community have reacted with little hostility. We had expected people to react violently, but no one has," he said.

Many people have expressed an interest in learning about homosexuality and accepting it who are not homosexual, Rogers noted, saying this is a healthy change in attitudes of the past.

Public image improved

Gay Liberation has helped transvestites, gay women and bisexual people improve their public image and relations with the

tipitate.

The majority of the i

Rogers said. "A gener that gay women are le due to the roles they p said. "Fewer gay wom level of consciousness

tion males have been has been unacceptable watched or feared in ti

Most women in ti

biexual or observers, because it is a lot easi places together and without suspicion meaz

DAZZLE UNICASE - O
Utopia Bold Display
UTOPIA BOLD DISPLAY
Utopia Black Headline
UTOPIA BLACK HEADLINE
Fraunces *Liebelgerda*

Utopia Regular
UTOPIA REGULAR

Utopia Subhead
UTOPIA SUBHEAD

Utopia Display
UTOPIA DISPLAY

Utopia Semibold
UTOPIA SEMIBOLD

Utopia Bold
UTOPIA BOLD

Utopia Black Headline
UTOPIA Black Headline

Utopia Regular
UTOPIA REGULAR

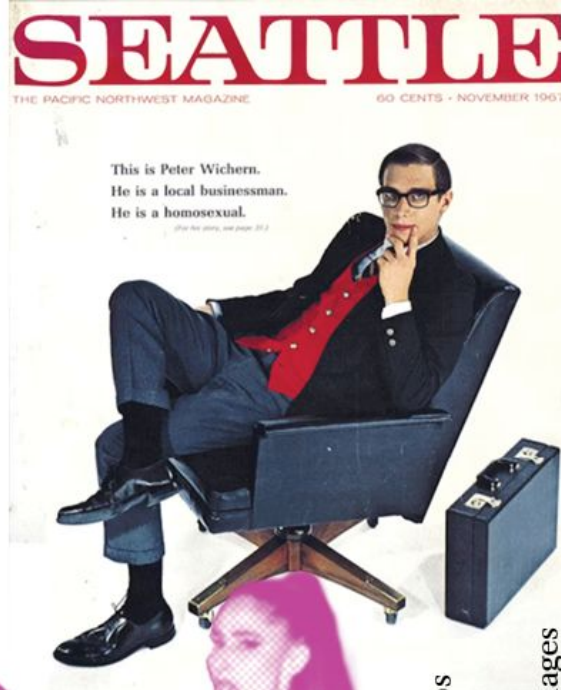
Utopia Subhead
UTOPIA SUBHEAD

Utopia Display
UTOPIA DISPLAY

Utopia Semibold
UTOPIA SEMIBOLD

Utopia Bold
UTOPIA BOLD

Utopia Black Headline
UTOPIA BLACK
HEADLINE



Vintage Photos
mixed with
textured
contemporary images



THOT BUBBLES
Image
INSPIRATION

illustration style, graphic elements, & textures

Clean-Maximalism

Frivolous

Reverent

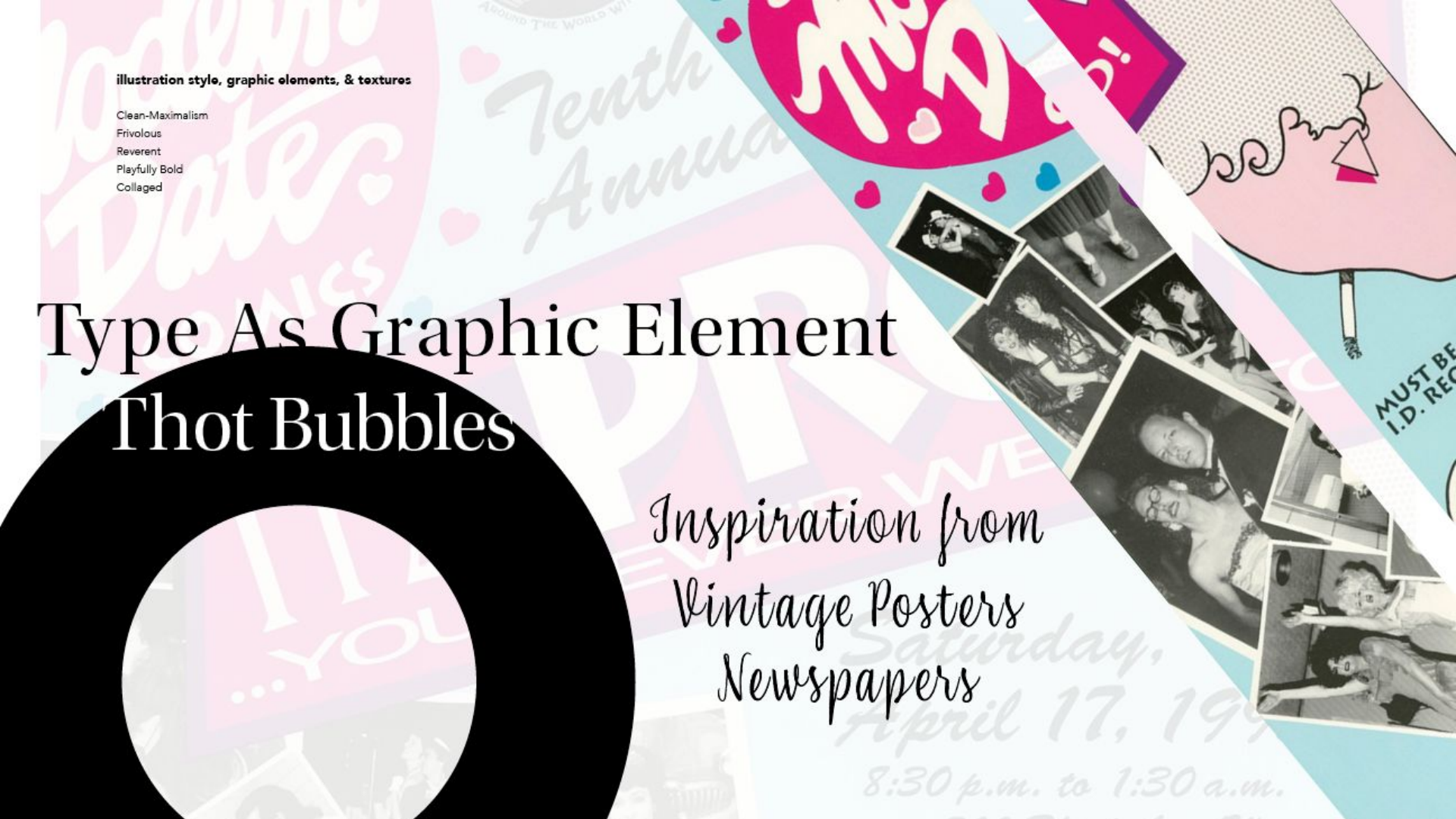
Playfully Bold

Collaged

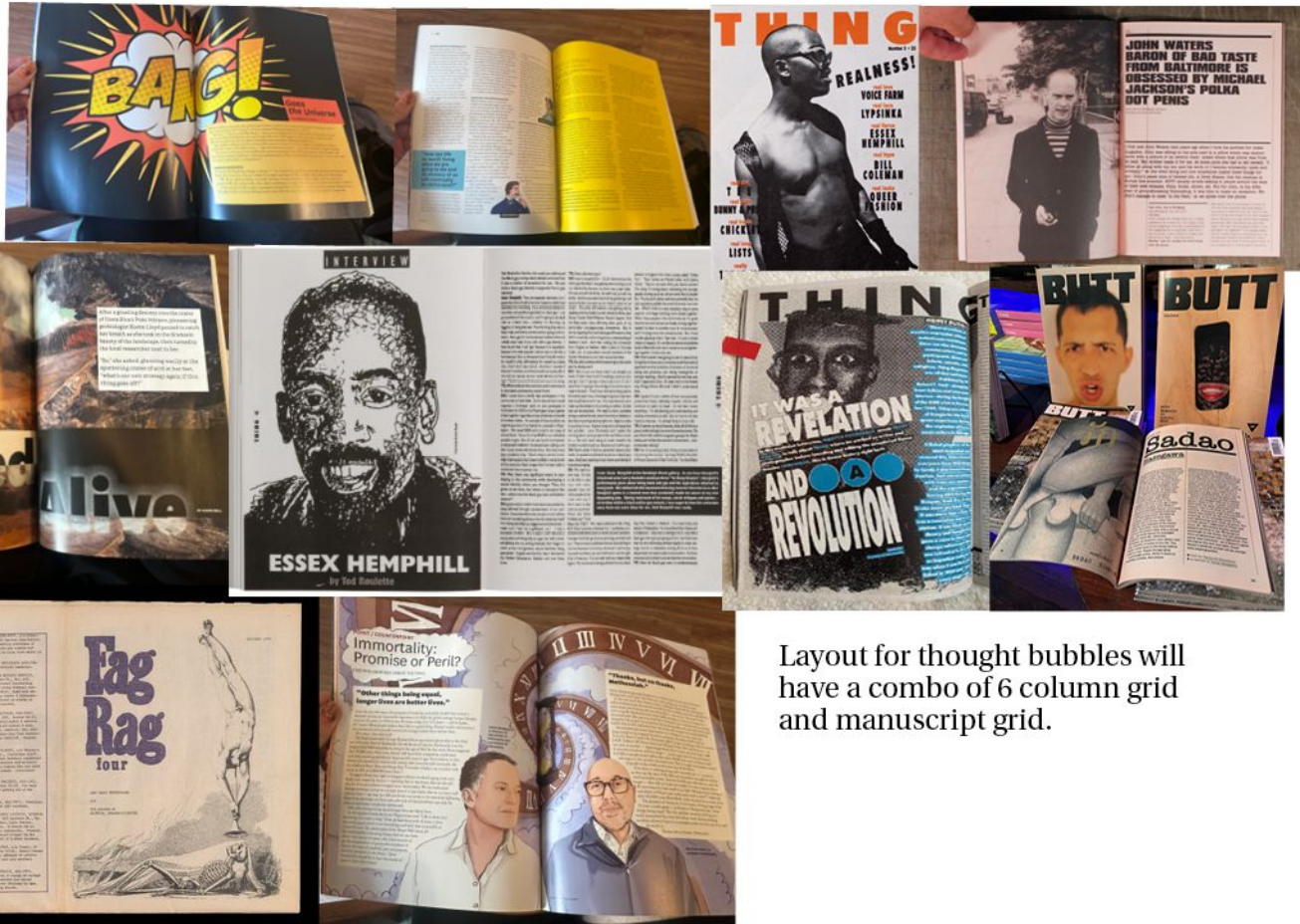
Type As Graphic Element

Thot Bubbles

Inspiration from
Vintage Posters
Newspapers



layout
inspiration



Layout for thought bubbles will
have a combo of 6 column grid
and manuscript grid.

Color Palette



vintage shades with pops



THOT 2 BUBBLES

*Contemporary faggotry
making love to queer history*



Layout

F/b-ob: Tight text box with
large image/ header

Image Page with tight text page
fro feature wells



Images

Layered collage
cropping

Candid photos
from events

Exhibitionist

Textured and
vintage



Gay Liberation 'trying to break down barriers'

By MARY ANN DREIER,
Daily Elliot Staff Writer
Gay Liberation, an organized force of
homosexuals at the University for two
years, is a group of students and University
employees politically and socially oriented
towards civil rights, according to Mark
Rogers, treasurer.

Gay Liberation was formed with a
decision dictated by members to break
down the stereotypes of homosexuals and to
"bring out" inhibited gay people into a
world they had been deliberately hidden and
excluded from in the past.

It has worked to expel a guilt society has
cast on the members through numerous
travels, dances, parties, panel discussions
on discrimination, and other activities where
homosexuals, heterosexuals, and bisexuals

Rogers said Gay Liberation had a conflict
with the Wigan, a local restaurant, for its
discrimination against gay people last year.
"But most people in the University
community have reacted with little
hostility. We had expected people to react
violently, but no one has," he said.

Many people have expressed an interest in
learning about homosexuality and accepting
it who are not homosexual, Rogers noted,
saying this is a healthy change in attitudes
of the past.

Public image improved
Gay Liberation has helped transvestites,
gay women and bisexual people improve
their public image and relations with the
straight world, at the same time improving
their own state of consciousness and

life.
The major
Rogers said,
that gay was
due to the re-
sult. "I never
level of con-
tation males
has been un-
valued or it
Most was
blatant or it
because it is
players' regre-
without sup-
"Contrary to
Gay Lib are

Type

Columnar
like news print.
Dense body text contrasted
with bold graphic headlines
but primarily not justified to
match zines of the time.



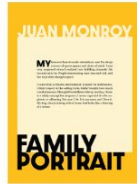


Candid photos
from events

Textured and
vintage

vintage subdued shades

F/b-ob: Tight text box
with large image/ header



Simple

Columnar
like news print.
Justified Text

to break down barriers

By MARY ANN DIEHL
Daily Illini Staff Writer

Gay Liberation, an organized force of homosexuals at the University for two years, is a group of students and University employees politically and socially oriented towards civil rights, according to Mark Rogers, treasurer.

Gay Liberation was formed with a direction dictated by members to break down the stereotypes of homosexuals and to "bring out" inhibited gay people into a world they had been deliberately hidden and excluded from in the past.

It has worked to expel a guilt society has cast on the dances through numerous teach-ins, marches, picnics, panel discussions in dormitories, and other activities where homosexuals, heterosexuals and bisexuals could meet one another and discuss their

Rogers said Gay Liberation had a conflict with the Wigwam, a local restaurant, for its discrimination against gay people last year. "But most people in the University community have reacted with little hostility. We had expected people to react violently, but no one has," he said.

Many people have expressed an interest in learning about homosexuality and accept it who are not homosexual. Rogers notes saying this is a healthy change in attitude of the past.

Public image improve
Gay Liberation has helped transvestite gay women and bisexual people improve their public image and relations with it straight world, at the same time improve their own state of consciousness as "getting their heads together," Rogers said.



Layered collage
cropping

Exhibitionist



vibrant pops



Image Page with
tight text page for feature wells

EXPRESSIVE

Dense body text
contrasted with
bold graphic
headlines
but primarily not
justified to match
zines of the time.





1



2



3



4



13



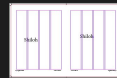
14



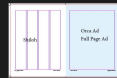
15



16



25



26



27



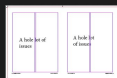
28



5



6



7



8



17



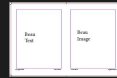
18



19



20



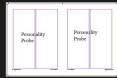
29



30



31



32



9



10



11



12



21



22



23



24



33



34



Notes on Camp

Homosexuals constitute the vanguard - and most articulate audience - of Camp.
—Susan Sontag

"Say 'Hey girl, haaaaay' ten times in the woods, and Kim Petras appears," a voice echoes. "Hey girl, haaaaay," somebody yells. At Triangle Recreation Camp, an 80-acre woodland getaway near Verlot, Wash., the conversation flows as freely as the mountain-fed river that runs through it. The two guys hollering between campsites may not know each other, but they will by the end of the weekend. I overhear them on my morning walkabout, where I've stopped to rest on a fallen log overlooking the river. I sip coffee from a thermos and watch the water eddy while fellow campers prepare for an afternoon of naked sunbathing, cold plunging, and maybe even cruising. Upstream from me, yesterday's beach party lingers in cheerful details: bright umbrellas, camping chairs with plastic wine glasses still nestled in their cupholders, a row of cairns someone built on the water's edge. Two eggplant inflatables curl in the sun, half-deflated. The first time my partner Michael and I visited TRC, it seemed like new delights greeted us hourly. The campground map directed us to sites with names like Trail Head, Into the Woods, and Knotty Pines. As we meandered, soon-to-be friends offered us helpings of group meals. We discovered the legendary bar known as the Gayzebo, where a camp icon from Canada and a fisherman from Oregon passed around bowls of frosted animal cookies under the sparkling glint of a rhinestone cowboy boot disco ball. Vintage gay porn played

on a big screen TV. At night the whole camp came together for a union suit meet-and-greet and dancing. Lumberjack go-go boys shimmied on platforms in the trees. Seven years later, TRC feels as delightful as ever. This weekend we're camping with Jeremy and Jeffrey, our Seattle friends. Earlier this morning at the picnic table, Jeffrey looped a kaftan around his head until its monstera pattern climbed into the sky. Jeremy cooked breakfast burritos wearing only a jock strap. "You look like Celine Dion on her wedding day," Jeremy said, cracking two eggs in a pan. "There's hope for me after all," Jeffrey said. "We always have hope," Jeremy said, dropping the shells in the carton. "We have to. As long as Diana Ross is Ashlee Simpson's mother-in-law. I heard that's the rule." Back at the river, the guys behind me keep chatting. I turn around to look. "When you're cute," a young guy says, stepping out of his tent, "all you need is chapstick and money."

"I've been working on shame with my therapist,"

"And a hot, steaming manhole," his friend says. "I can hear your funeral now," a third guy says, transferring hard seltzers into a day cooler. "He had a kind demeanor and Slavic cheekbones, but all he ever packed was moisturizer, Metamucil, and ballcaps." I'm half-watching the river when something familiar but wrong catches my eye. The usual turquoise and yellow chairs in the Sanctuary—they're there, but I see new signs. Capping my thermos, I walk downtrail. A small log fence separates this area from the main camp. Laminated memorial signs wreathed in yellow and peach flowers commemorate John F. Limitone and Chris Napenias. Earlier on my walk, up the road by the trailers and RVs, I saw another memorial for Adam Gretzinger. I brush off a chair and sit. The urge to know more overtakes me. I pull out my phone and type the names in a notepad. I remember their faces from around here. There's no service at camp, but maybe today or tomorrow I'll talk with someone who knows them. From my sitspot, I can hear another group of men



JUAN MONROY

My interests lean towards subcultures and the sharp corners of queer spaces and states of mind. I was very surprised when I realized how fulfilling domestic life turned out to be. People intertwining over time and trial, and the ways they change a space.

I came from a chaotic environment. I coped via restlessness. I didn't expect to like setting roots, I didn't realize how much comfort means. I thought I would have to keep moving. Home is a tricky concept for us queers. I never expected it to be euphoric or affirming. But now I do. It is my mess and I love it. My dog, always staring at that house that looks like a drawing of a house.

Family Portrait
oil on canvas
48 x 48 in
2025

FAMILY PORTRAIT



JUAN MONROY

MY interests lean towards subcultures and the sharp corners of queer spaces and states of mind. I was very surprised when I realized how fulfilling domestic life turned out to be. People intertwining over time and trial, and the ways they change a space.

I came from a chaotic environment. I coped via restlessness. I didn't expect to like setting roots, I didn't realize how much comfort means. I thought I would have to keep moving. Home is a tricky concept for us queers. I never expected it to be euphoric or affirming. But now I do. It is my mess and I love it. My dog, always staring at that house that looks like a drawing of a house.

FAMILY PORTRAIT



FAMILY PORTRAIT OIL ON CANVAS 48 X 48 IN 2025



NOTES ON CAMP

Written by D. Smith

Homosexuals constitute the vanguard — and most articulate audience — of Camp.

—Susan Sontag

Say 'Hey girl, haaaaay' ten times in the woods, and Kim Petras appears," a voice echoes.

"Hey girl, haaaaay," somebody yells. At Triangle Recreation Camp, an 80-acre woodland getaway near

Verlot, Wash., the conversation flows as freely as the mountain-fed river that runs through it. The two guys hollering between campsites may not know each other, but they will by the end of the weekend. I overhear them on my morning walk-about, where I've stopped to rest on a fallen log overlooking the river. I sip coffee from a thermos and watch the water eddy while fellow campers prepare for an afternoon of naked sunbathing, cold plunging, and maybe even cruising.

Upstream from me, yesterday's beach party lingers in cheerful details: bright umbrellas, camping chairs with plastic wine glasses still nestled in their cupholders, a row of cairns someone built on the water's edge. Two eggplant inflatables curl in the sun, half-deflated.

The first time my partner Michael and I visited TRC, it seemed like new delights greeted us hourly. The campground map directed us to sites with names like Trail Head, Into the Woods, and Knotty Pines. As we meandered, soon-to-be friends offered us helpings of group meals. We discovered the legendary bar known as the Gayzebo, where a camp icon from Canada and

a fisherman from Oregon passed around bowls of frosted animal cookies under the sparkling glint of a rhinestone cowboy boot disco ball. Vintage gay porn played on a big screen TV. At night the whole camp came together for a union suit meet-and-greet and dancing. Lumberjack go-go boys shimmed on platforms in the trees. Seven years later, TRC feels as delightful as ever.

This weekend we're camping with Jeremy and Jeffrey, our Seattle friends. Earlier this morning at the picnic table, Jeffrey looped a kaftan around his head until its monstera pattern climbed into the sky. Jeremy cooked breakfast burritos wearing only a jock strap.

"You look like Celine Dion on her wedding day," Jeremy said, cracking two eggs in a pan.

"There's hope for me after all," Jeffrey said.

"We always have hope," Jeremy said, dropping the shells in the carton. "We have to. As long as Diana Ross is Ashlee Simpson's mother-in-law. I heard that's the rule."

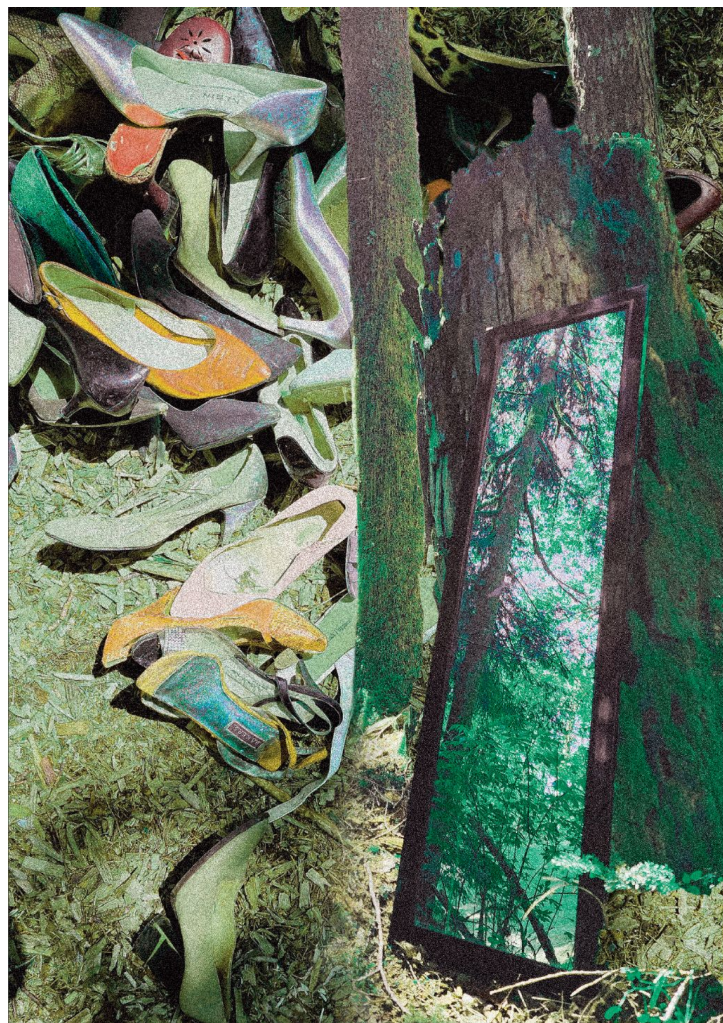
Back at the river, the guys behind me keep chatting. I turn around to look. "When you're cute," a young guy says, stepping out of his tent, "all you need is chapstick and money."

"And a hot, steaming manhole," his friend says.

"I've been working on shame with my therapist"

I can hear your funeral now," a third guy says, transferring hard seltzers into a day cooler. "He had a kind demeanor and Slavic cheekbones, but all he ever packed was moisturizer, Metamucil, and ballcaps." I'm half-watching the river when something familiar but wrong catches my eye. The usual turquoise and yellow chairs in the Sanctuary—they're there, but I see new signs.

Capping my thermos, I walk downtrail. A small log fence separates this area from the main



Article Lead

Say 'Hey girl, haaaaay' ten times in the woods, and Kim Petras appears," a voice echoes.

"Hey girl, haaaaay," somebody yells. At Triangle Recreation Camp, an 80-acre woodland getaway near Verlot, Wash., the conversation flows as freely as the mountain-fed river that runs through it. The two guys hollering between campsites may not know each other, but they will by the end of the weekend. I overhear them on my morning walkabout, where I've stopped to rest on a fallen log overlooking the river. I sip coffee from a thermos and watch the water eddy while fellow campers prepare for an afternoon of naked sunbathing, cold plunging, and maybe even cruising.

Upstream from me, yesterday's beach party lingers in cheerful details: bright umbrellas, camping chairs with plastic wine glasses still nestled in their cupholders, a row of cairns someone built on the water's edge. Two eggplant inflatables curl in the sun, half-deflated.

The first time my partner Michael and I visited TRC, it seemed like new delights greeted us hourly. The campground map directed us to sites with names like Trail Head, Into the Woods, and Knotty Pines. As we meandered, soon-to-be friends offered us helpings of group meals. We discovered the legendary bar known as the Gayzebo, where a camp icon from Canada and a fisherman from Oregon passed around bowls of frosted animal cookies under the sparkling glint of a rhinestone cowboy boot disco ball. Vintage gay porn played on a big screen TV. At night the whole camp came together for a union suit meet-and-greet and dancing. Lumberjack go-go boys shimmed on platforms in the trees. Seven years later, TRC feels as delightful as ever. This weekend we're camping with Jeremy and Jeffrey, our Seattle friends. Earlier this morning at the picnic table, Jeffrey looped a kaftan around his head until its monstera pattern climbed into the sky. Jeremy cooked breakfast burritos wearing only a jock strap.

"You look like Celine Dion on her wedding day," Jeremy said, cracking two eggs in a pan.

"There's hope for me after all," Jeffrey said.

10 Thot Bubbles

"We always have hope," Jeremy said, dropping the shells in the carton. "We have to. As long as Diana Ross is Ashlee Simpson's mother-in-law. I heard that's the rule."

Back at the river, the guys behind me keep chatting. I turn around to look. "When you're cute," a young guy says, stepping out of his tent, "all you need is chapstick and money."

"And a hot, steaming manhole," his friend says.

I can hear your funeral now," a third guy says, transferring hard seltzers into a day cooler. "He had a kind demeanor and Slavic cheekbones, but all he ever packed was moisturizer, Metamucil, and ballcaps."

I'm half-watching the river when something familiar but wrong catches my eye. The usual turquoise and yellow chairs in the Sanctuary—they're there, but I see new signs. Capping my thermos, I walk downtrail. A small log fence separates this area from the main camp. Laminated memorial signs wreathed in yellow and peach flowers commemorate John F. Limitone and Chris Napenias. Earlier on my walk, up the road by the trailers and RVs, I saw another memorial for Adam Gretzinger. I brush off a chair and sit.

The urge to know more overtakes me. I pull out my phone and type the names in a notepad. I remember their faces from around here. There's no service at camp, but maybe today or tomorrow I'll talk with someone who knows them.

From my sitspot, I can hear another group of men behind me. "I've been working on shame with my therapist," a guy says.

"And your takeaway was realizing you had enough of it to transfer your items from Amazon Prime bags into a beach bag."

"Baby steps."

The morning light filters through the canopy and feels bucolic, like I've entered a kind of homosexual Eden. Daisies, dandelions, and lupines grow on the riverbank, not far from the eggplant floaties. My contemplations about life and death are balanced by my

ay 'Hey girl, haaaaay' ten times in the woods, and Kim Petras appears," a voice echoes.

"Hey girl, haaaaay," somebody yells. At Triangle Recreation Camp, an 80-acre woodland getaway near Verlot, Wash., the conversation flows as freely as the mountain-fed river that runs through it. The two guys hollering between campsites may not know each other, but they will by the end of the weekend. I overhear them on my morning walkabout, where I've stopped to rest on a fallen log overlooking the river. I sip coffee from a thermos and watch the water eddy while fellow campers prepare for an afternoon of naked sunbathing, cold plunging, and maybe even cruising.

Upstream from me, yesterday's beach party lingers in cheerful details: bright umbrellas, camping chairs with plastic wine glasses still nestled in their cupholders, a row of cairns someone built on the water's edge. Two eggplant inflatables curl in the sun, half-deflated.

The first time my partner Michael and I visited TRC, it seemed like new delights greeted us hourly. The campground map directed us to sites with names like Trail Head, Into the Woods, and Knotty Pines. As we meandered, soon-to-be friends offered us helpings of group meals. We discovered the legendary bar known as the Gayzebo, where a camp icon from Canada and a fisherman from Oregon passed around bowls of frosted animal cookies under the sparkling glint of a rhinestone cowboy boot disco ball. Vintage gay porn played on a big screen TV. At night the whole camp came together for a union suit meet-and-greet and dancing. Lumberjack go-go boys shimmed on platforms in the trees. Seven years later, TRC feels as delightful as ever. This weekend we're camping with Jeremy and Jeffrey, our Seattle friends. Earlier this morning at the picnic table, Jeffrey looped a kaftan around his head until its monstera pattern climbed into the sky. Jeremy cooked breakfast

burritos wearing only a jock strap.

"You look like Celine Dion on her wedding day," Jeremy said, cracking two eggs in a pan.

"There's hope for me after all," Jeffrey said.

"We always have hope," Jeremy said, dropping the shells in the carton. "We have to. As long as Diana Ross is Ashlee Simpson's mother-in-law. I heard that's the rule."

Back at the river, the guys behind me keep chatting. I turn around to look. "When you're cute," a young guy says, stepping out of his tent, "all you need is chapstick and money."

"And a hot, steaming manhole," his friend says.

I can hear your funeral now," a third guy says, transferring hard seltzers into a day cooler. "He had a kind demeanor and Slavic cheekbones, but all he ever packed was moisturizer, Metamucil, and ballcaps."

I'm half-watching the river when something familiar but wrong catches my eye. The usual turquoise and yellow chairs in the Sanctuary—they're there, but I see new signs. Capping my thermos, I walk downtrail. A small log fence separates this area from the main camp. Laminated memorial signs wreathed in yellow and peach flowers commemorate John F. Limitone and Chris Napenias. Earlier on my walk, up the road by the trailers and RVs, I saw another memorial for Adam Gretzinger. I brush off a chair and sit.

The urge to know more overtakes me. I pull out my phone and type the names in a notepad. I remember their faces from around here. There's no service at camp, but maybe today or tomorrow I'll talk with someone who knows them.

From my sitspot, I can hear another group of men behind me. "I've been working on shame with my therapist," a guy says.

"And your takeaway was realizing you had enough of it to transfer your items from Amazon Prime bags into a beach bag."

"Baby steps."

The morning light filters through the canopy and feels bucolic, like I've entered a kind of homosexual Eden. Daisies, dandelions, and

Thot Bubbles 11

Article Lead Feature Wells

Say 'Hey girl, haaaaay' ten times in the woods, and Kim Petras appears," a voice echoes.

"Hey girl, haaaaay," somebody yells. At Triangle Recreation Camp, an 80-acre woodland getaway near Verlot, Wash., the conversation flows as freely as the mountain-fed river that runs through it. The two guys hollering between campsites may not know each other, but they will by the end of the weekend. I overhear them on my morning walkabout, where I've stopped to rest on a fallen log overlooking the river. I sip coffee from a thermos and watch the water eddy while fellow campers prepare for an afternoon of naked sunbathing, cold plunging, and maybe even cruising.

Upstream from me, yesterday's beach party lingers in cheerful details: bright umbrellas, camping chairs with plastic wine glasses still nestled in their cupholders, a row of cairns someone built on the water's edge. Two eggplant inflatables curl in the sun, half-deflated.

The first time my partner Michael and I visited TRC, it seemed like new delights greeted us hourly. The campground map directed us to sites with names like Trail Head, Into the Woods, and Knotty Pines. As we meandered, soon-to-be friends offered us helpings of group meals. We discovered the legendary bar known as the Gayzebo, where a camp icon from Canada and a fisherman from Oregon passed around bowls of frosted animal cookies under the sparkling glint of a rhinestone cowboy boot disco ball. Vintage gay porn played on a big screen TV. At night the whole camp came together for a union suit meet-and-greet and dancing. Lumberjack go-go boys shimmied on platforms in the trees. Seven years later, TRC feels as delightful as ever. This weekend we're camping with Jeremy and Jeffrey, our Seattle friends. Earlier this morning at the picnic table, Jeffrey looped a kaftan around his head until its monstera pattern climbed into the sky. Jeremy cooked breakfast burritos wearing only a jock strap.

"You look like Celine Dion on her wedding day," Jeremy said, cracking two eggs in a pan.

"There's hope for me after all," Jeffrey said.

8 Thot Bubbles

"We always have hope," Jeremy said, dropping the shells in the carton. "We have to. As long as Diana Ross is Ashlee Simpson's mother-in-law. I heard that's the rule."

Back at the river, the guys behind me keep chatting. I turn around to look. "When you're cute," a young guy says, stepping out of his tent, "all you need is chapstick and money."

"And a hot, steaming manhole," his friend says.

I can hear your funeral now, a third guy says, transferring hard seltzers into a day cooler. "He had a kind demeanor and Slavic cheekbones, but all he ever packed was moisturizer, Metamucil, and ballcaps."

I'm half-watching the river when something familiar but wrong catches my eye. The usual turquoise and yellow chairs in the Sanctuary—they're there, but I see new signs.

Capping my thermos, I walk downtrail. A small log fence separates this area from the main camp. Laminated memorial signs wreathed in yellow and peach flowers commemorate John F. Limitone and Chris Napenias. Earlier on my walk, up the road by the trailers and RVs, I saw another memorial for Adam Gretzinger. I brush off a chair and sit.

The urge to know more overtakes me. I pull out my phone and type the names in a notepad. I remember their faces from around here. There's no service at camp, but maybe today or tomorrow I'll talk with someone who knows them.

From my sitspot, I can hear another group of men behind me. "I've been working on shame with my therapist," a guy says.

"And your takeaway was realizing you had enough of it to transfer your items from Amazon Prime bags into a beach bag."

"Baby steps."

The morning light filters through the canopy and feels bucolic, like I've entered a kind of homosexual Eden. Daisies, dandelions, and lupines grow on the riverbank, not far from the eggplant floaties. My contemplations about life and death are balanced by my fellow campers' unfiltered dialogue, born of



SAY 'Hey girl, haaaaay' ten times in the woods, and Kim Petras appears," a voice echoes.

"Hey girl, haaaaay," somebody yells.

At Triangle Recreation Camp, an 80-acre woodland getaway near Verlot, Wash., the conversation flows as freely as the mountain-fed river that runs through it. The two guys hollering between campsites may not know each other, but they will by the end of the weekend. I overhear them on my morning walkabout, where I've stopped to rest on a fallen log overlooking the river. I sip coffee from a thermos and watch the water eddy while fellow campers prepare for an afternoon of naked sunbathing, cold plunging, and maybe even cruising.

Upstream from me, yesterday's beach party lingers in cheerful details: bright umbrellas, camping chairs with plastic wine glasses still nestled in their cupholders, a row of cairns someone built on the water's edge. Two eggplant inflatables curl in the sun, half-deflated.

The first time my partner Michael and I visited TRC, it seemed like new delights greeted us hourly. The campground map directed us to sites with names like Trail Head, Into the Woods, and Knotty Pines. As we meandered, soon-to-be friends offered us helpings of group meals. We discovered the legendary bar known as the Gayzebo, where a camp icon from Canada and a fisherman from Oregon passed around bowls of frosted animal cookies under the sparkling glint of a rhinestone cowboy boot disco ball. Vintage gay porn played on a big screen TV. At night the whole camp came together for a union suit meet-and-greet and dancing. Lumberjack go-go boys shimmied on platforms in the trees. Seven years later, TRC feels as delightful as ever. This weekend we're camping with Jeremy and Jeffrey, our Seattle friends. Earlier this morning at the picnic table, Jeffrey looped a kaftan around his head until its monstera pattern climbed into the sky. Jeremy cooked breakfast burritos wearing only a jock strap.

"You look like Celine Dion on her wedding day,"

Jeremy said, cracking two eggs in a pan.

"There's hope for me after all," Jeffrey said.

"We always have hope," Jeremy said, dropping the shells in the carton. "We have to. As long as Diana Ross is Ashlee Simpson's mother-in-law. I heard that's the rule."

Back at the river, the guys behind me keep chatting. I turn around to look. "When you're cute," a young guy says, stepping out of his tent, "all you need is chapstick and money."

"And a hot, steaming manhole," his friend says.

I can hear your funeral now, a third guy says, transferring hard seltzers into a day cooler. "He had a kind demeanor and Slavic cheekbones, but all he ever packed was moisturizer, Metamucil, and ballcaps."

I'm half-watching the river when something familiar but wrong catches my eye. The usual turquoise and yellow chairs in the Sanctuary—they're there, but I see new signs.

Capping my thermos, I walk downtrail. A small log fence separates this area from the main camp. Laminated memorial signs wreathed in yellow and peach flowers commemorate John F. Limitone and Chris Napenias. Earlier on my walk, up the road by the trailers and RVs, I saw another memorial for Adam Gretzinger. I brush off a chair and sit.

The urge to know more overtakes me. I pull out my phone and type the names in a notepad. I remember their faces from around here. There's no service at camp, but maybe today or tomorrow I'll talk with someone who knows them.

From my sitspot, I can hear another group of men behind me. "I've been working on shame with my therapist," a guy says.

"And your takeaway was realizing you had enough of it to transfer your items from Amazon Prime bags into a beach bag."

"Baby steps."

The morning light filters through the canopy and feels bucolic, like I've entered a kind of homosexual Eden. Daisies, dandelions, and lupines grow on the riverbank, not far from the eggplant floaties. My contemplations

Thot Bubbles 9

Article Lead Feature Well

Say 'Hey girl, haaaaay' ten times in the woods, and Kim Petras appears," a voice echoes. "Hey girl, haaaaay," somebody yells.

At Triangle Recreation Camp, an 80-acre woodland getaway near Verlot, Wash., the conversation flows as freely as the mountain-fed river that runs through it. The two guys hollering between campsites may not know each other, but they will by the end of the weekend. I overhear them on my morning walkabout, where I've stopped to rest on a fallen log overlooking the river. I sip coffee from a thermos and watch the water eddy while fellow campers prepare for an afternoon of naked sunbathing, cold plunging, and maybe even cruising. Upstream from me, yesterday's beach party lingers in cheerful details: bright umbrellas, camping chairs with plastic wine glasses still nestled in their cupholders, a row of cairns someone built on the water's edge. Two eggplant inflatables curl in the sun, half-deflated. The first time my partner Michael and I visited TRC, it seemed like new delights greeted us hourly. The campground map directed us to sites with names like Trail Head, Into the Woods, and Knotty Pines. As we meandered, soon-to-be friends offered us helpings of group meals. We discovered the legendary bar known as the Gayzebo, where a camp icon from Canada and a fisherman from Oregon passed around bowls of frosted animal cookies under the sparkling glint of a rhinestone cowboy boot disco ball. Vintage gay porn played on a big screen TV. At night the whole camp came together for a union suit meet-and-greet and dancing. Lumberjack go-go boys shimmied on platforms in the trees. Seven years later, TRC feels as delightful as ever. This weekend we're camping with Jeremy and Jeffrey, our Seattle friends. Earlier this morning at the picnic table, Jeffrey looped a kaftan around his head until its monstera pattern climbed into the sky. Jeremy cooked breakfast burritos wearing only a jock strap. "You look like Celine Dion on her wedding day," Jeremy said, cracking two eggs in a pan.

"There's hope for me after all," Jeffrey said. "We always have hope," Jeremy said, dropping the shells in the carton. "We have to. As long as Diana Ross is Ashlee Simpson's mother-in-law. I heard that's the rule." Back at the river, the guys behind me keep chatting. I turn around to look. "When you're cute," a young guy says, stepping out of his tent, "all you need is chapstick and money." "And a hot, steaming manhole," his friend says.

I can hear your funeral now," a third guy says, transferring hard seltzers into a day cooler. "He had a kind demeanor and Slavic cheekbones, but all he ever packed was moisturizer, Metamucil, and ballcaps." I'm half-watching the river when something familiar but wrong catches my eye. The usual turquoise and yellow chairs in the Sanctuary—they're there, but I see new signs. Capping my thermos, I walk downtrail. A small log fence separates this area from the main camp. Laminated memorial signs wreathed in yellow and peach flowers commemorate John F. Limitone and Chris Napenias. Earlier on my walk, up the road by the trailers and RVs, I saw another memorial for Adam Gretzinger. I brush off a chair and sit. The urge to know more overtakes me. I pull out my phone and type the names in a notepad. I remember their faces from around here. There's no service at camp, but maybe today or tomorrow I'll talk with someone who knows them. From my sitspot, I can hear another group of men behind me. "I've been working on shame with my therapist," a guy says. "And your takeaway was realizing you had enough of it to transfer your items from Amazon Prime bags into a beach bag."

"Baby steps."

The morning light filters through the canopy and feels bucolic, like I've entered a kind of

Say 'Hey girl, haaaaay' ten times in the woods, and Kim Petras appears," a voice echoes. "Hey girl, haaaaay," somebody yells. At Triangle Recreation Camp, an 80-acre woodland getaway near Verlot, Wash., the conversation flows as freely as the mountain-fed river that runs through it. The two guys hollering between campsites may not know each other, but they will by the end of the weekend. I overhear them on my morning walkabout, where I've stopped to rest on a fallen log overlooking the river. I sip coffee from a thermos and watch the water eddy while fellow campers prepare for an afternoon of naked sunbathing, cold plunging, and maybe even cruising.

Upstream from me, yesterday's beach party lingers in cheerful details: bright umbrellas, camping chairs with plastic wine glasses still nestled in their cupholders, a row of cairns someone built on the water's edge. Two eggplant inflatables curl in the sun, half-deflated. The first time my partner Michael and I visited TRC, it seemed like new delights greeted us hourly. The campground map directed us to sites with names like Trail Head, Into the Woods, and Knotty Pines. As we meandered, soon-to-be friends offered us helpings of group meals. We discovered the legendary bar known as the Gayzebo, where a camp icon from Canada and a fisherman from Oregon passed around bowls of frosted animal cookies under the sparkling glint of a rhinestone cowboy boot disco ball. Vintage gay porn played on a big screen TV. At night the whole camp came together for a union suit meet-and-greet and dancing. Lumberjack go-go boys shimmied on platforms in the trees. Seven years later, TRC feels as delightful as ever. This weekend we're camping with Jeremy and Jeffrey, our Seattle friends. Earlier this morning at the picnic table, Jeffrey looped a kaftan around his head until its monstera pattern climbed into the sky. Jeremy cooked breakfast burritos wearing only a jock strap. "You look like Celine Dion on her wedding day," Jeremy said, cracking two eggs in a pan.

"There's hope for me after all," Jeffrey said. "We always have hope," Jeremy said, dropping the shells in the carton. "We have to. As long as Diana Ross is Ashlee Simpson's mother-in-law. I heard that's the rule." Back at the river, the guys behind me keep chatting. I turn around to look. "When you're cute," a young guy says, stepping out of his tent, "all you need is chapstick and money." "And a hot, steaming manhole," his friend says.

I can hear your funeral now," a third guy says, transferring hard seltzers into a day cooler. "He had a kind demeanor and Slavic cheekbones, but all he ever packed was moisturizer, Metamucil, and ballcaps." I'm half-watching the river when something familiar but wrong catches my eye. The usual turquoise and yellow chairs in the Sanctuary—they're there, but I see new signs. Capping my thermos, I walk downtrail. A small log fence separates this area from the main camp. Laminated memorial signs wreathed in yellow and peach flowers commemorate John F. Limitone and Chris Napenias. Earlier on my walk, up the road by the trailers and RVs, I saw another memorial for Adam Gretzinger. I brush off a chair and sit. The urge to know more overtakes me. I pull out my phone and type the names in a notepad. I remember their faces from around here. There's no service at camp, but maybe today or tomorrow I'll talk with someone who knows them. From my sitspot, I can hear another group of men behind me. "I've been working on shame with my therapist," a guy says. "And your takeaway was realizing you had enough of it to transfer your items from Amazon Prime bags into a beach bag."

"Baby steps."

The morning light filters through the canopy and feels bucolic, like I've entered a kind of homosexual Eden. Daisies, dandelions, and lupines grow on the riverbank, not far from the eggplant floaties. My contemplations

Article Lead Poems

We met

Last First Date

We met at my favorite theater.
The one with shaky seats
and screen burned walls,
where I always sit alone
in the same row,
in the same seat,
my church made from flickering
light.
I had never let anyone into that
sanctuary,
but there she was.
Just a little taller than I imagined,
stepping through the entrance
like she'd always belonged
in my quiet world.
When our eyes met,
my breath caught
like the hush in a theater
before the first note breaks the
dark.
She looked at me
with warmth,
and I searched her face
for something wrong.
Some flicker of disinterest,
some subtle wince
anything to prove
that I had read this all wrong.
But there was nothing,
only softness.
Only the terrifying miracle
of being wanted
exactly as I am.
We arrived late,
missed the first few minutes.
I lied and said
she hadn't missed much
just to keep her close,
to buy time
to explain everything
she'd ever want to know.
I was grateful for the darkness.
Grateful that the screen
lit her cheekbones
and not my trembling hands.
Even someone like me,
dense,
hesitant,
accustomed to missed signals
could feel her enthusiasm

in the way she leaned
in.
The way her body
answered mine.
Her arm slowly curled around
mine.
Her head found my shoulder.
I kept my face forward
like I wasn't unraveling
at every gentle touch.
It took me three quarters
of the movie
to take her hand.
Once I did,
I had to count my breaths
just to remember
how to stay alive.
Eight hundred and fifty-six.
That's how many more it took
for the credits to roll,
for her to let go,
and for the world to restart.
I didn't let go
until the usher asked us to leave.
And when I did
the cold of her absence
hit me like a truth
I had no name for.
She asked to keep the night
going.
I said yes
of course, yes.
We walked arm-in-arm to her car
and my stomach churned
thinking of my messy room,
a space too real
for someone this incandescent.
(It wasn't clean.
She said it was fine,
I chose to believe her.)
We sat on my floor
cross-legged
playing my favorite icebreaker
game
while the hours spun
like warm laundry.
Every question she answered
felt like a key,
a name,

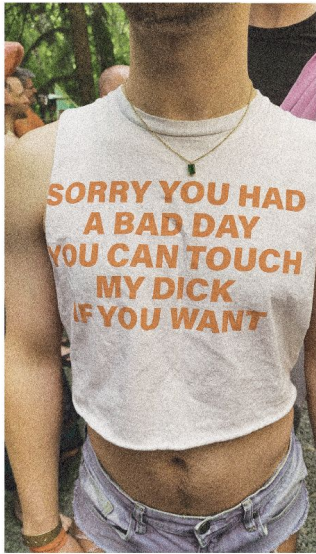
Article Lead Arts Section

MY interests lean towards subcultures and the sharp corners of queer spaces and states of mind. I was very surprised when I realized how fulfilling domestic life turned out to be. People intertwining over time and trial, and the ways they change a space.

I came from a chaotic environment. I coped via restlessness. I didn't expect to like setting roots, I didn't realize how much comfort means. I thought I would have to keep moving. Home is a tricky concept for us queers. I never expected it to be euphoric or affirming. But now I do. It is my mess and I love it. My dog, always staring at that house that looks like a drawing of a house.

MY interests lean towards subcultures and the sharp corners of queer spaces and states of mind. I was very surprised when I realized how fulfilling domestic life turned out to be. People intertwining over time and trial, and the ways they change a space.

I came from a chaotic environment. I coped via restlessness. I didn't expect to like setting roots, I didn't realize how much comfort means. I thought I would have to keep moving. Home is a tricky concept for us queers. I never expected it to be euphoric or affirming. But now I do. It is my mess and I love it. My dog, always staring at that house that looks like a drawing of a house.



"And your takeaway was realizing you had enough to transfer your items from Amazon Prime bags into a beach bag."

The morning light filters through the canopy and feels bucolic, like I've entered a kind of homosexual Eden. Daisies, dandelions, and lupines grow on the riverbank, not far from the egg-plant floaties. My contemplations about life and death are balanced by my fellow campers' unfiltered dialogue, born of our absurd and colorful world.

I'm part of the absurdity too, of course, another voice in the chorus. Just this weekend, my friends and I weighed the pros and cons of calling female spray tan technicians "women in science." We debated which supporting actress in Brokeback Mountain deserves more acclaim, Michelle Williams or Anne Hathaway.

Last night I argued for an hour with a man probably ten years my senior about which song lyric more significantly impacted the American employment rate: Britney's "work, bitch" or Beyoncé modeling the virtues of quitting one's job. At one point the man paused. This wasn't an either-or, he said. We needed to consider Dolly Parton's begrudging acceptance of the 9-to-5 grind as well.

The morning light filters through the canopy and feels bucolic, like I've entered a kind of homosexual Eden.

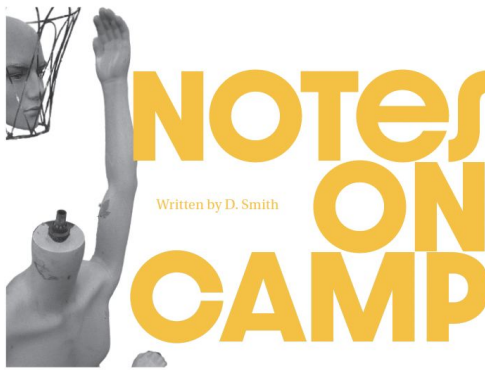
"It'll drive you crazy if you let it," I said. Such gabfests can seem surface-level, but they're a way of wading in. That conversation, for example, drifted into a discussion of the next generation of young gay men. The man said he hoped teenagers coming out these days would lead healthy lives, especially compared to those of us who postponed adolescence and later needed therapy, or spent our twenties and thirties reassuring our inner children. "Me too," I said, "but their youth can still be insufferable." "Just with a better work-life balance than the rest of us combined."

I'm half-watching the river when something familiar but wrong catches my eye. The usual turquoise and yellow chairs in the Sanctuary—they're there, but there are some new signs, too.

Capping my thermos, I walk downtrail. A small log fence separates this area from the main camp. Laminated memorial signs wreathed in yellow and peach flowers commemorate John F. Limitone and Chris Napenias. Earlier on my walk, up the road by the trailers and RVs, I saw another memorial for Adam Gretzinger. I brush off a chair and sit down.

The urge to know more overtakes me. I pull out my phone and type the names in a notepad. I remember their faces from around here. There's no cell service at camp, but maybe today or tomorrow I'll talk with someone who knows them.

From my sitspot in the Sanctuary, I can hear another group of men behind me. "I've been working on shame with my therapist," a guy says.



Written by D. Smith

Homosexuals constitute the vanguard — and most articulate audience — of Camp. —Susan Sontag

A y "Hey girl, haaaaay" ten times in the woods, and Kim Petras appears, "a voice echoes. "Hey girl, haaaaay," somebody yells.

At Triangle Recreation Camp, an 80-acre woodland getaway near Verlot, Wash., the conversation flows as freely as the mountain-fed river that runs through it. The two guys hollering between campsites may not know each other, but they will by the end of the weekend. I overhear them on my morning walkabout, where I've stopped to rest on a fallen log overlooking the river. I sip coffee from a thermos and watch the water eddy while fellow campers prepare for an afternoon of naked sunbathing, cold plunging, and maybe even cruising.

Upstream from me, yesterday's beach party lingers in cheerful details: bright umbrellas, camping chairs with plastic wine glasses nestled in their cupholders, a row of cairns some-one built on the water's edge. Two eggplant inflatables curl in the sun, half-deflated.

The first time my partner Michael and I visited TRC, it seemed like new delights greeted us hourly. The campground map directed us to sites with names like Trail Head, Into the Woods, and Knotty Pines.

As we meandered, soon-to-be friends offered us helpings of group meals. We discovered the legendary bar known as the Gayzebo, where a camp icon from Canada and a fisherman from Oregon passed around bowls of frosted animal cookies under the sparkling glint of a rhinestone cowboy boot disco ball. Vintage gay porn played on a big screen TV. At night the whole camp came together for a union suit-themed meet-and-greet and dancing. Lumberjack go-go boys shimmed on platforms in the trees.

Seven years later, TRC feels as delightful as ever. This weekend we're camping with Jeremy and Jeffrey, our Seattle friends. Earlier this morning at the picnic table, Jeffrey looped a kaftan around his head until its monstera pattern climbed into the sky. Jeremy cooked breakfast burritos wearing only a jock strap.

"You look like Celine Dion on her wedding day," Jeremy said, cracking two eggs in a pan. "There's hope for me after all," Jeffrey said. "We always have hope," Jeremy said, dropping the shells in the carton. "We have to. As long as Diana Ross is Ashlee Simpson's mother-in-law." "That is the rule," Jeffrey said.

"I've been working on shame with my therapist"

Back at the river, the guys behind me are still chatting. I turn around and look. "When you're cute," a young guy says, stepping out of a tent, "all you need is chapstick and money." "And a hot, steaming manhole," his friend says. "I can hear your funeral now," a third guy says, transferring hard seltzers into a day cooler. "He had a kind demeanor and Slavic cheekbones, but all he ever packed was moisturizer, Metamucil, and ballcaps."

only three men.

Some lovely, some painful, none vegetable.

But this?

This is the first time I've been sure I want the last.

And I will do whatever it takes to make this my last first date.

I WILL DO WHATEVER IT TAKES TO MAKE THIS MY LAST FIRST DATE.

I. LAST FIRST DATE

We met at my favorite theater

The one with shaky seats and seven burned walls, where I always sit alone in the same row, in the same seat, my church made from flickering light.

I had never let anyone into that sanctuary, but there she was.

Just a little taller than I imagined, stepping through the entrance like she'd always belonged in my quiet world.

When our eyes met, my breath caught like the hush in a theater before the first note breaks the dark.

She looked at me with warmth, and I searched her face for something wrong.

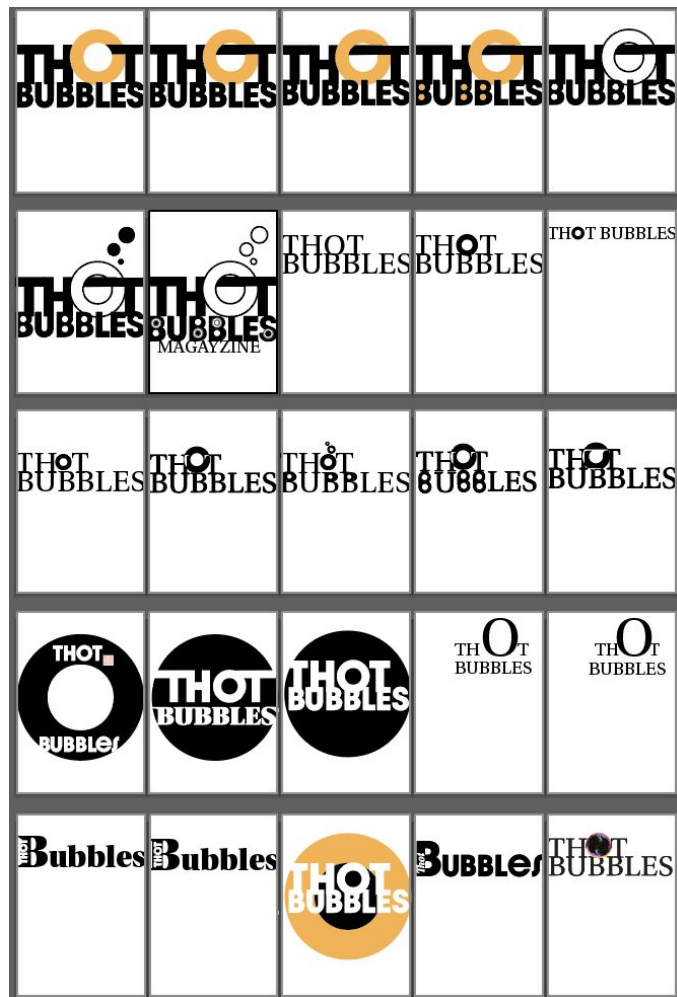
Some flicker of disinterest, some subtle voice anything to prove that I had read this all wrong.

But there was nothing, only softness.

When our eyes met, my breath caught like the hush in a theater before the first note breaks the dark.



THOT BUBBLES MAGAYZINE



THE HOT BUBBLES

Editor and Chief
N. Swenson

Executive Editor
D. Smith

Our guest contributors

Donatello Dreakford
Randy Ford
Shiloh Davies
Juan Monroy
Scotty Cayton
Beau Degas

Special Thanks To

The 2026 SCCA Cohort
For feedback, inspiration and friendship

Jill Corey
Anything you like about the skill, layout, and styling of this magazine is thanks to her incredible teachings.

Funded in part by the



OFFICE OF ARTS & CULTURE

SEATTLE

CONTEMPORARY FAGGOTRY

MAKING LOVE TO QUEER HISTORY

Vol 2 Issue # 150

Tacky Tourist Clubs of America Present
THE PROM

NEVER WENT TO!

SAT. MAY 7

WAY CENTER
AUDITORIUM
RD AVE. W
OMAS ST

THE HOT BUBBLES

MAGazine

J. Edgar Hoover
Chief

Bill Hunter, Safety Patrol,
Office Assistant, Junior Bell
Blatant Government Agent
Rough Lungs

Tomie

Gertrude Stein
Poet

Walter Whitman
Poet

Bessie Smith
Singer

Elaine Noble
Dancer

Literary Arts, French Club
Girls' Basketball, Art League

Literary Arts, English Club
Future Nurses of America

Pg. 28 THE OUTSIDER

BE ARED

HIV/STI Testing

Every First Friday, in partnership with
POCAAN

STEAM
WORKS bath

May we recover from the first.

May the scars from this one be no worse.

May this handful of vitamins jumpstart our plans.

May we bring enough bedsheets for the picnic to expand.

May our stone-butched lover play some Sapphic high-femme grooves.

May the volleyball players doing a fundraiser work their Spandex suits.

May our queeridescence swagger elevate the vibes around the pool.

May we proclaim that TKO stands for "Tina Knowles Original."

May we hydrate these thirsts like daisies in a Mason jar.

May we become the hoes we want to be / like to say we are.

May we get the details for whatever ABC party we're looking for.

May we tip well when Aqua Dom and Sub Marine perform.

May the bathrooms have short lines and open stalls.

May muscle-sexuals flaunt standard-issue balls.

May they hit up archival dicks for one more round.

May the long walk home coax a few hot bubbles out.

May we curl up under our soft Weighty Gaga on the couch.

May the spicy chicken sandwich from Burger King be sublime.

May we look out the window and see prayers in the sky.

May we hear echoes of regret from other times.

And reach for gifts as they dip close by.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

I. LAST FIRST DATE

DONATELLO DREAKFORD..... P. 6

NOTES ON CAMP

D. SMITH..... P. 10

TRC, MUMUS, & MIMOSAS

D. SMITH..... P. 16

FAMILY PORTRAIT

JUAN MONROY..... P. 18

DEPTH SUBJ

JUAN MONROY..... P. 20

THE PROM YOU NEVER WENT TO

RANDY HENSON, D. SMITH..... P. 22

PROM POSTERS

RANDY HENSON..... P. 28

PONY GRAFFITI VOL.1

N. SWENSON..... P. 6

MEDITATIONS IN VAIN

N. SWENSON..... P. 6

THE LOVELY LOOKS OF

BEAU DEGAS..... P. 6

PONY GRAFFITI VOL.1

N. SWENSON..... P. 6

MEDITATIONS IN VAIN

N. SWENSON..... P. 44

YOU CAN'T DO IT ALL ON YOUR OWN

SCOTTY CAYTON..... P. 48

EGGENDER

SCOTTY CAYTON..... P. 50

SOFT SERVES WITH

SHILOH DAVIES, N. SWENSON... P. 52

THE ONLY COMPLETELY CONCLUSIVE PERSONALITY PROBE

D. SMITH..... P. 56

THE LAST GAY PRAYER

D. SMITH..... P. 60



Editor and Chief
N. Swenson

Executive Editor
D. Smith

Our guest contributors

Donatello Dreakford
Randy Ford
Shiloh Davies
Juan Monroy
Scotty Cayton
Beau Degas

Special Thanks To

The 2026 SCCA Cohort
For feedback, inspiration and friendship

Jill Corey
Anything you like about the skill, layout, and styling of this
magazine is thanks to her incredible teachings.

Funded in part by the



OFFICE OF ARTS & CULTURE

SEATTLE

JUAN MONROY

MY interests lean towards subcultures and the sharp corners of queer spaces and states of mind. I was very surprised when I realized how fulfilling domestic life turned out to be. People intertwining over time and trial, and the ways they change a space.

I came from a chaotic environment. I coped via restlessness. I didn't expect to like setting roots, I didn't realize how much comfort means. I thought I would have to keep moving. Home is a tricky concept for us queers. I never expected it to be euphoric or affirming. But now I do. It is my mess and I love it. My dog, always staring at that house that looks like a drawing of a house.

FAMILY PORTRAIT



"FAMILY PORTRAIT" OIL ON CANVAS 48 X 48 IN 2025



NOTES ON CAMP

D. Smith

Homosexuals constitute the vanguard —
and most articulate audience — of Camp.
—Susan Sontag

Say 'Hey girl, haaaaay' ten times in the woods, and Kim Petras appears," a voice echoes. "Hey girl, haaaaay," somebody yells. At Triangle Recreation Camp, an 80-acre woodland getaway near Verlot, Wash., the conversation flows as freely as the mountain-fed river that runs through it. The two guys hollering between campsites may not know each other, but they will by the end of the weekend. I overhear them on my morning walkabout, where I've stopped to rest on a fallen log overlooking the river. I sip coffee from a thermos and watch the water eddy while fellow campers prepare for an afternoon of naked sunbathing, cold plunging, and maybe even cruising.

Upstream from me, yesterday's beach party liners in cheerful details: bright umbrellas, camping chairs with plastic wine glasses nestled in their cupholders, a row of cairns someone built on the water's edge. Two eggplant inflatables curl in the sun, half-deflated.

The first time my partner Michael and I visited TRC, it seemed like new delights greeted us hourly. The campground map directed us to sites with names like Trail Head, Into the Woods, and

Knotty Pines. As we meandered, soon-to-be friends offered us helpings of group meals. We discovered the legendary bar known as the Gayzebo, where a camp icon from Canada and a fisherman from Oregon passed around bowls of frosted animal cookies under the sparkling glint of a rhinestone cowboy boot disco ball. Vintage gay porn played on a big screen TV. At night the whole camp came together for a union suit-themed meet-and-greet and dancing. Lumberjack go-go boys shimmied on platforms in the trees.

Seven years later, TRC feels as delightful as ever. This weekend we're camping with Jeremy and Jeffrey, our Seattle friends. Earlier this morning at the picnic table, Jeffrey looped a kaftan around his head until its monstera pattern climbed into the sky. Jeremy cooked breakfast burritos wearing only a jock strap.

"You look like Celine Dion on her wedding day," Jeremy said, cracking two eggs in a pan.

"There's hope for me after all," Jeffrey said.

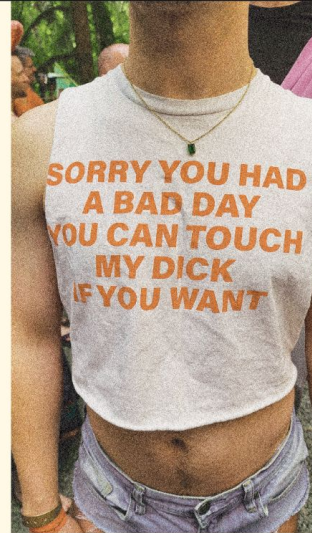
"We always have hope," Jeremy said, dropping the shells in the carton. "We have to. As long as Diana Ross is Ashlee Simpson's mother-in-law." "That is the rule," Jeffrey said.

**"I've been working on shame
with my therapist"**

Back at the river, the guys behind me are still chatting. I turn around and look. "When you're cute," a young guy says, stepping out of a tent, "all you need is chapstick and money."

"And a hot, steaming manhole," his friend says. "I can hear your funeral now," a third guy says, transferring hard seltzers into a day cooler. "He had a kind demeanor and Slavic cheekbones, but all he ever packed was moisturizer, Metamucil, and ballcaps."





I'm half watching the river when something familiar but wrong catches my eye. The usual turquoise and yellow chairs in the Sanctuary—they're there, but there are some new signs, too.

Capping my thermos, I walk downtrail. A small log fence separates this area from the main camp. Laminated memorial signs wreathed in yellow and peach flowers commemorate John F. Limitone and Chris Napenias. Earlier on my walk, up the road by the trailers and RVs, I saw another memorial for Adam Gretzinger. I brush off a chair and sit down. The urge to know more overtakes me. I pull out my phone and type the names in a notepad. I remember their faces from around here. There's no cell service at camp, but maybe today or tomorrow I'll talk with someone who knows them.

From my sitspot in the Sanctuary, I can hear another group of men behind me. "I've been working on shame with my therapist," a guy says.

"And your takeaway was realizing you had enough to transfer your items from Amazon Prime bags into a beach bag." The morning light filters through the canopy and feels bucolic, like I've

entered a kind of homosexual Eden. Daisies, dandelions, and lupines grow on the riverbank, not far from the eggplant floaties. My contemplations about life and death are balanced by my fellow campers' unfiltered dialogue, born of our absurd and colorful world.

I'm part of the absurdity too, of course, another voice in the chorus. Just this weekend, my friends and I weighed the pros and cons of calling female spray tan technicians "women in science." We debated which supporting actress in *Brokeback Mountain* deserves more acclaim, Michelle Williams or Anne Hathaway.

Last night I argued for an hour with a man probably ten years my senior about which song lyric more significantly impacted the American employment rate: Britney's "work, bitch" or Beyoncé modeling the virtues of quitting one's job. At one point the man paused. This wasn't an either-or, he said. We needed to consider Dolly Parton's begrudging acceptance of the 9-to-5 grind as well.

"It'll drive you crazy if you let it," I said. Gabfests can seem surface-level, but they're a way of wading in. That conversation, for example, drifted into a discussion of the next generation of young gay men. The man said he hoped teenagers coming out these days would lead healthy lives, especially compared to those of us who postponed adolescence and later needed therapy, or spent our twenties and thirties reassuring our inner children.

"Me too," I said.

"but their youth can still be insufferable."

"Just with a better work-life balance than the rest of us combined."

Spruce and fir needles flutter and land on the empty turquoise and yellow chairs around me. I grab my thermos and continue down the trail. Chatter ensues.

"My outfit depends on the strength of this one safety pin."

"She's crying for help."

"The safety pin?"

"You, silly."

During our last visit here, I overheard an older camper mention missing someone whose life was cut short by HIV/AIDS. Michael and I were gathered around a friend's campfire. The theme that night was "angels and demons."

"The morning light filters through the canopy and feels bucolic"

had cardboard wings at my feet, and Michael's devil tail poked out from the back of his chair. I hesitated, then scooted closer to the guy talking. He was someone I'd connected with at the Gayzebo. He wasn't shy, and he always dressed to the theme. That night he had cardboard tubes fashioned into horns jutting from his head.

"When did you start coming here?" I asked.

"Early nineties," I asked if he wanted anything from the bar, a folding table stacked with bottles and manned by an angel in a halo made from a paper plate and tinfoil. He said sure, a vodka soda. After picking my way through the scattered lawn chairs and waiting a few minutes, I returned with our drinks. He was poking the fire with a stick. I knew what I wanted to ask him.

What he told me that night stays with me: that he and his friends wondered if insurance companies would count HIV as a preexisting condition, if the government would use STI test results to create a registry of gays they could target, if chapped lips came before bleeding gums, or vice versa.

"Jesus," I said, for probably the tenth time. "I remember my friends and I laughing about hate crimes possibly decreasing because straight

men wouldn't want to touch the blood after punching us."

Hours later, the path to my tent felt unsteady under my feet. The hangover lasted days, both from drinking too much and from the weight of a loss I had

missed but was now inheriting. The plague years had happened while I was growing up in a small town, where AIDS afflicted other people in distant cities, not us, not yet, not where I could see.

My hangover this morning is simpler. I can find my way out of it. After coffee, I'll pop some Advil and have a mimosa while wearing a mumu.

I cut away from the river. My crew is probably getting ready for the beach by now, packing a cooler of seltzers, water, and energy drinks. If I take two Five Hour Energies, I wonder, will I get ten



hours of energy? Or twice the amount of energy for five hours?

I pass a tent with a Nicki Minaj flag on it and hear a voice inside: "Do you think we have more friends we eventually hooked up with, or more hookups who eventually became our friends?"

"You're all going to be my friend after we figure out this forest douche." A beat of silence, then laughter—at the ridiculousness of being here, gay in the woods, somehow under- and over-packed for everything. As I walk past the site and round the corner, a few guys with tote bags pass, and I'm struck by the sweetness of this Sunday: this flamboyance of highly acerbic yet wildly generous men carrying their folding chairs and flamingo floaties and dog-eared novels and Bluetooth speakers and boxes of cheap rosé, the shadows of deer ferns crossing their feet as they walk.

If we're lucky, there'll be campers here next summer, the summer after that, and many summers into the future. I'm sure the campers will be like us in some ways, and in some ways not. "Some of them were the kind of gays who spent their high school years shablammung in the lunchroom," one might say, remembering. "And some of them were the kind of gays who looked for packets of free lube by the cash register at the underwear store."

"True," his older friend will say.

"We had to prepare for survival."



During our last visit here, I overheard an older camper mention missing someone whose

THE ONLY COMPLETELY CONCLUSIVE PERSONALITY PROBE

D. Smith

1. DP!!!! I love...

- a. Dolly Parton
- b. Double Penetration
- c. Domestic Partnerships
- d. Dick Pics

1. Answer _____

2. Best TV

- a. Girls, beach house episode
- b. Sex and the City, bisexual episode
- c. The Last of Us, gay episode
- d. Golden Girls, HIV episode

1. Answer _____

2. Best Cinderella

- a. Brandy (Cinderella, 1997)
- b. Hilary Duff (A Cinderella Story, 2004)
- c. Selena Gomez (Another Cinderella Story, 2008)
- d. Camila Cabello (Cinderella, 2021)

1. Answer _____

4. I wear my scarf...

- a. reverse draped
- b. looped and tucked
- c. braided and pretzeled
- d. like a shawl

1. Answer _____

5. My softball team:

- a. Baby Back Butches
- b. Throwt Goats
- c. Bunt Cakes
- d. Scissors in the Outfield

1. Answer _____

6. Super-sexy song lyric:

- a. Lil' Kim making a Sprite can disappear in her mouth
- b. Meshell Ndegeocello asking if she can "kiss you there"
- c. Cardi B sucking a watermelon through a straw
- d. Missy Elliott's "Ra-ta-ta-ta, ta-ta-ta-ta"

1. Answer _____

7. Formative Muppet:

- a. Gladys the Cow (Sesame Street)
- b. Beaker, assistant to Bunsen (The Muppet Show)
- c. Skeeter, Scooter's tomboy twin (Muppet Babies)
- d. Janice, guitar player (The Muppet Show)

1. Answer _____

8. Fave holiday/drug pairing:

- a. molly on Memorial Day
- b. vallum on Valentine's Day
- c. ketamine on Christmas
- d. post-Pride doxycycline

1. Answer _____

9. Tasked with providing the lube:

- a. insertive partner
- b. receptive partner
- c. videographer/s
- d. venue

1. Answer _____

10. When I journal, I become...

- a. Jo March
- b. Regina George
- c. Clarissa Darling
- d. Sylvia Plath

1. Answer _____

11. Fave Julia Roberts:

- a. Tinkerbell in Hook
- b. Vivian in Pretty Woman
- c. Julianne in My Best Friend's Wedding
- d. Erin in Erin Brokovich

1. Answer _____

12. Most skilled Drag Race choreographer:

- a. Todrick Hall
- b. Jamal Sims
- c. Alyssa Edwards
- d. Miguel Zarate

1. Answer _____

13. Least annoying celeb sibling:

- a. Frankie Grande
- b. Ashlee Simpson
- c. Dannii Minogue
- d. Haylie Duff

1. Answer _____

14. My tagline for *Real Housewives of Seattle*:

- a. "Hot enough to melt the Seattle freeze."
- b. "I make these other bitches evergreen with envy."
- c. "Watch your back, I'm always sleepless in Seattle."
- d. "This blonde roast doesn't pull any shots."

15. Most relatable celeb alter ego:

- a. Beyoncé's Sasha Fierce
- b. Nicki Minaj's Roman Zolanski
- c. Janelle Monáe's Cindi Mayweather
- d. David Bowie's Ziggy Stardust

16. Once while watching porn, I saw...

- a. a Beats by Dre pill on the floor
- b. a dual-dial air fryer on the kitchen counter
- c. a deck of Magic the Gathering cards
- d. an RBG biography

COUNT YOUR TOTALS.

of As:

of Bs:

of Cs:

of Ds:

RESULTS

MOSTLY A'S.

You're a rare gem—your friends think of you as a spiritual first responder, and they're right. Musically, you prefer "I'm A Survivor" by Reba McEntire to "Survivor" by Destiny's Child. Socially, you can be dynamic—a Blanche in the company of straight acquaintances and a Dorothy among gays. Deep down, you feel like Meghan Markle, the Duchess of Sussex, suffering through the early years of public life with Prince Harry. Your dream pet is Mantacore, the white tiger who attacked Roy Horn of Siegfried & Roy during a Las Vegas magic show in 2003. Your favorite Cazwell music video is "Rice & Beans." As you move forward, remember the disparity between how you perceive yourself and how others perceive you barely exists.

MOSTLY C'S.

You're a magnificent mortal—expressing Wyourself as freely as Lafayette on True Blood. Musically, you prefer "Motivation" by Normani to "Motivation" by Kelly Rowland. From a generational perspective, you possess the resilience of the Greatest Generation and the ingenuity of Gen Alpha. In your heart, you are Billy Porter entering the 2019 Met Gala wearing a bejeweled catsuit and ten-foot wings, reclining on a velvet couch carried by six shirtless men. Inexplicably, your favorite Cazwell music video is "Ice Cream Truck." Your dream pet is a black and white Boston Terrier. The best advice now is to remember that self-knowledge is also your path to being there for others, exactly as they need you.

MOSTLY B'S.

You're a trouble-making dyke who always said corporate pride would fail to meet the political action needs of the community—and you were right. This wisdom brings a calming influence to your social circles. Musically, you prefer "Come On Over" by Shanla Twain to "Come on Over Baby (All I Want Is You)" by Christina Aguilera. You share personality traits with celebrities like Rosa Diaz from Brooklyn Nine-Nine and Ally Brooke from Fifth Harmony. You have the resourcefulness of Kimberly, the white Power Ranger, and the intelligence of Billy, the blue one. Your dream pet is Rocco, the tuxedo cat of Auli'i Cravalho, the American actress who voiced Moana. Your inner diva lights up rooms and radiates queer chaos.

MOSTLY D'S.

You silly faggot—sorry: "vivacious mixture of whimsy and vulnerability." Your dream pet is Chouette, the blue-cream tortie Birman cat of late German fashion designer Karl Lagerfel. Musically, you prefer "Pound the Alarm" by Nicki Minaj to "Ring the Alarm" by Beyoncé. You openly approve of the universally-maligned short-lived reality TV show Real Friends of West Hollywood, yet your thoughts about Caitlyn Jenner's politics remain private but valid. As time passes, remember the gap between how you see yourself on good days and how you see yourself on bad days shrinks with every Nasty Pig purchase. The perfect mesh tank top embroidered with a snout logo is out there. Keep shopping.

“ah ha” moments? (and some “AAAAHH!” moments)

((and some haha moments))

Research and Recipe

- WouldaCouldaShoulda

*^ pulled in more examples of article *type* and not just time period and subject matter.*

^researched MORE MORE MORE since the recipe is SUCH a deeply important tool.

- Recipe changed!

^ I asked Jill at what point the magazine becomes a new recipe and got great insight back.

Visual Communication

- Artsy Fartsy and Gay!

^ Would love to try a minimalist, calm, or academic magazine to really get structural, formal layout practice.

^ Deeply enjoyed getting to challenge my maximalism with consistency.

Fulfilling The Original Problem

- Real Collaborators!

- Volleyball of the Contemporary and Historical

^in content and design

Titan

K

V

W

X

Y

Z